

**NYU**Human Research
Protection Program

RESEARCH INFORMED CONSENT FORM

STUDY TITLE: Mandarin Lexical Tone Study (IRB-FY2025-10331)

INVESTIGATOR(S): Alec Marantz; Yuqi (Vicky) Ling

INVITATION TO BE A PART OF A RESEARCH STUDY

You are invited to participate in a research study. This form has information to help you decide whether you wish to participate - please review it carefully. Your participation is voluntary. Please ask any questions you have about the study or about this form before deciding to participate.

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY

The purpose of this study is to investigate how the brain processes lexical tones in Sinitic tonal languages such as Mandarin, and how these tones interact with word meaning when we are listening to natural speech.

ELIGIBILITY TO PARTICIPATE

You are eligible to participate in this study if you are 18 years or older, speak Mandarin fluently, began speaking Mandarin before the age of 7, and are able to read Chinese.

You should not participate if you began speaking Mandarin at age 7 or later or are unable to read Chinese.

To determine if you are eligible, we will ask you to complete a questionnaire with your language background.

DESCRIPTION OF STUDY PROCEDURES

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

1. Read through this consent form and click the button below to agree to participate in this study.
2. You will then be redirected to the instructions of the experiment. You will listen to a series of Mandarin words and be asked to match them with the correct Chinese characters via button presses. And you will then be asked to do a rating of the recording of the words. You will begin with a few practice rounds with feedback. This should take no more than 5 minutes.
3. After the practice, you will proceed to the main task which will be identical to the practice, but without feedback. The main task should last about 25 minutes.

4. After the main task, you will then listen to a list of recordings of words, and you will be asked to judge if you have heard of the same recordings in the main task. The judgement should take no more than 10 minutes.
5. After completing all the tasks, you will receive a questionnaire to fill out about your language background.
6. Upon completing the questionnaire, you will be redirected to Prolific. You will receive payment via the Prolific platform after the study is fully complete by all participants.

RISKS OR DISCOMFORTS

This study involves the following risks or discomforts: While there are measures put in place by the researcher to secure data, there is always a risk of a potential breach of confidentiality.

Please tell the researchers if you believe you are harmed from your participation in the study.

BENEFITS

It is hoped that this study will contribute to knowledge about how speech is processed (i.e. understood) in tonal languages, (i.e. languages in which pitch patterns distinguish word meaning).

While there are no direct benefits to the participant, participants will be helping expand our knowledge of how speech is processed and will learn more about the study of neurolinguistics.

COMPENSATION

You will receive \$17.00 (USD) via Prolific for your participation.

VOLUNTARY PARTICIPATION

Participating in this study is completely voluntary. You may choose not to take part in the study or to stop participating at any time, for any reason, without penalty or negative consequences.

If you withdraw or are withdrawn from the study early, then we will not keep information about you that is already collected.

PRIVACY & DATA CONFIDENTIALITY

In this study, you may be asked to provide information that could be used to identify you personally. This information will be kept confidential. Only researchers and others that will keep the information confidential (e.g., regulatory agencies or oversight groups) may access information that could personally identify you.

Future Use of Data

Information about you collected for this study may be shared with other researchers, used for other research studies, or placed in a data repository. These studies may be similar to this study or completely different. All information that could identify you will be removed before sharing the

data or using it for other research studies. We will not ask you for additional permission before sharing the information.

ACCESS TO YOUR STUDY INFORMATION

We will not give you access to the information that is collected about you in this study.

CONTACT INFORMATION

You are encouraged to ask questions at any time during this study. For information about the study, contact Yuqi (Vicky) Ling at (718) 839-4392, yl10096@nyu.edu, or their faculty sponsor, Alec Marantz at (212) 998-7950, ma988@nyu.edu.

If you have questions about your rights as a research participant or if you believe you have been harmed from the research, please contact the NYU Human Research Protection Program at (212)998-4808 or ask.humansubjects@nyu.edu.

AGREEMENT TO PARTICIPATE

By checking below, you are agreeing to participate in this study. Make sure you understand what the study involves before you agree. If you have questions about the study after you agree to participate, you can contact the research team using the information provided above. You may [print/keep] a copy of this form.

☐ *I agree to participate in this research study.*